

11 HUMAN RELATIONSHIPS



Before machines, the only form of entertainment people really had was relationships.

Doug Coupland

Almost all of our relationships begin and most of them continue as forms of mutual exploitation, a mental or physical barter, to be terminated when one or both parties run out of goods.

W. H. Auden

□ VOCABULARY INPUT

Dealing with this topic you will come across the following vocabulary. Read it and look up the unknown words in your dictionary.

- **human relationships:** friendship, siblings, partnership, kinship, cohabitation, marriage, love affair
 - *informal* (family, friends, classmates, peers, colleagues, neighbours)
 - *formal* (teachers and students, employers and employees, doctors and patients, etc.)
 - *short-term/long-term*
- **ways of creating relationships:** getting to know each other, making friends, going out with someone
- **human values and priorities:** liking, love, friendship, tolerance, acceptance, faith, support, loyalty, fairness, honesty, care, trust, empathy, satisfaction, encouragement, willingness
- **in fruitful relationships:** people are on good terms, get on with each other, get along with, care about each other, listen to each other, give each other a hand, give someone a shoulder to cry on, solve problems together, argue calmly, do not take each other for granted, rejuvenate their good feelings for each other, share secrets, stay in touch with each other, devote time to each other, hang out with each other
- **features of non-functional relationships:** reluctance, carelessness, ignorance, selfishness, jealousy, excuses, lack of interest, infidelity, neglecting each other, split up, break up, separation, divorce

□ DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

Before reading the text, discuss the following questions in class.

1. Why are relationships important in our lives?
2. What kind of relationship do you have with your parents and siblings?
3. What are the qualities that make real friends?
4. What do friends mean to you?
5. How do you care about your friends?
6. In what ways can people get to know each other?
7. What kinds of relationships require more formality and politeness?
8. How do you think formal relationships can become informal?
9. What kind of relationship should there be between students and their teachers?
10. Why are relationships difficult nowadays?

□ TEXT

Read the texts below in silence. Check the meaning of the words in bold and answer the questions below.

HUMAN RELATIONSHIPS

Humans are social beings. Therefore creating relationships is an **essential need** that must be **fulfilled**. A human relationship describes the way people **get on with each other**, talk and **behave towards each other**. Relationships are created between grandparents and parents, parents and their children, between siblings, married couples, friends, men and women, **employees** and **employers**, etc. The quality of relationships with others **reflects** our own personality. It is our choice who we talk to, how we **treat** other people, how much time and energy we are **willing** to spend with them. Nowadays, human relationships are very complicated. Many people are **stressed out**, busy and tired. A **valued** relationship is something that cannot be bought for money as it is about feelings, **empathy**, understanding, **trust**, **care**, **politeness** and **satisfaction**. Keeping a functioning relationship with a life partner, best friends, family members or colleagues is much more difficult than **bringing one to an end**.

1. Which types of relationships are mentioned in the text?
2. Why does the quality of our relationships reflect our personality?

FAMILY

There are **short-term** and **long-term** relationships. Some relationships **last** forever beginning from early childhood. Families are the basic social units in which informal relationships are formed. **Besides** other roles, one of the most important is for parents to **raise their children in accordance with** socially accepted norms and **patterns of behaviour**. Children **observe** how their parents talk, behave to their relatives, friends, colleagues and **strangers**. Then, they behave **accordingly** in their **adulthood**. A good relationship with one's parents is very important. Someone still **at war** with his or her parents is probably not ready for peace and **companionship** with a romantic partner.

3. Why is the family important in terms of human relationships?
4. What patterns of behaviour should parents show their children when raising them?

MARRIAGE

Some relationships are created for a short period of time. It is the same with marriages. Normally, two people get married because they want to spend their whole life together. **However**, after some time they may find out that their relationship has **weakened** and the reasons why they should live together are no longer **applicable**. Statistics show that a **high rate of divorce** is caused by love **disappearing**, a lack of **faith** and trust, financial problems and **addiction** to alcohol, drugs or gambling. A happy **marriage** represents the ideal human

relationship in which each partner feels free to be what he or she is **by nature**. Similar **values**, ethnic backgrounds, interests, IQs, religions and lifestyles are the most important **ingredients** in lasting relationships. Couples who can discuss **honestly** whatever is important to them – **including** their relationship – are happier and more likely to have lasting love. Sometimes it may be **painful** to hear that a relationship is not satisfying. But talking about feelings and listening to each other are both **vital** for happiness. In a **fruitful argument**, each partner explains why he or she is **mad** while the other one listens with respect. Long-term happy couples also tend to **argue calmly**. **Loss** of control, **yelling** or **sobbing** seldom help **solve** problems. Successful couples do not **take each other for granted** but work constantly at **rejuvenating** their good feelings towards each other.

5. What makes a marriage last?
6. Which are the most common reasons for divorce according to the writer?

FRIENDSHIP

Friendship is a relationship between people who **have** something **in common**, spend a lot of time together, **support** and help each other when necessary. Friends are people who laugh together, speak about everything and **share secrets**. They show their true feelings. They **accept each other** as they are. They look at each other and see a great person, one they love spending time with. Friends are **tied** by memories, tears, **laughter** and smiles. True friends are people who are always there for you. Friendship is about giving and getting **equally**. The saying "*A friend in need is a friend indeed*" shows the full value of friendship. There is no place for **jealousy**, ignorance and **excuses**. We make friends during every **stage** of our lives. Some friendships last a short time, others for our whole life. If we want to keep our friends for a long time, we should **stay in touch with** them, send e-mails, call them, send **occasional** cards, exercise together or go to lunch **at least** once a month. Some friendships lose importance and **die out**. It happens when friends stop contacting each other or because of **unresolved** arguments. When there is a conflict, it should be **resolved** by confrontation or **talking it out**.

7. How is friendship defined in the text above?
8. Why do some friendships end?

FORMAL RELATIONSHIPS

Besides marriage and friendship, there are other sorts of formal relationships formed among people at school, work and in other institutions. Formal relationships are not very **deep** and open. They are formed among people of different ages, social and professional positions: teachers and students, employers and employees, doctors and patients, etc. Such relationships **require** respect and a higher level of formality and politeness.

9. What does a "formal relationship" mean?
10. What typical examples of formal relationship are given in the text above?

□ VOCABULARY LIST

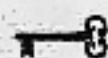
accordingly – podľa toho
addiction – závislosť
adulthood – dospelosť
applicable – použiteľný
besides – okrem
by nature – prirodzene, od prírody
care – starostlivosť, pozornosť
companionship – spoločenstvo, priateľstvo
deep – hlboký
to die out – vymrieť, zaniknúť
to disappear – zmiznúť
employee [em'plɔɪi:] – zamestnanec
employer [em'plɔɪə(r)] – zamestnávateľ
empathy [empəθi] – empatia
equally [i:kwəli] – rovnako
essential – nevyhnutný
excuse – výhovorka
faith – viera
fruitful argument – plodná debata
to fulfill – spĺňať
honestly [ɒnɪstli, AmE a:nɪstli] – úprimne, otvorene
however – avšak
including – vrátane
indeed [ɪn'di:d] – samozrejme, naozaj
ingredient – prísada
jealousy [dʒeləsi] – žiarlivosť
to last – trvať
laughter [la:ftə(r)] – smiech
long-term – dlhodobý
loss (of) – strata
mad – nahnevaný, rozčúlený
marriage – manželstvo
need – potreba
to observe – pozorovať
occasional [ə'keɪʒnl] – príležitostný
painful – bolestivý
patterns of behaviour – modely správania
politeness – zdvorilosť
to reflect – odrážať
to rejuvenate [rɪdʒu:vəneɪt] – oživiť, obnoviť
to require [rɪkwaɪə(r)] – vyžadovať

to resolve – vyriešiť
satisfaction – uspokojenie
short-term – krátkodobý
to sob – vzlykať
to solve – (vy)riešiť
stage – štádium, etapa, obdobie
stranger – neznámy človek
stressed out – vystresovaný
to support – podporovať
to talk out – prediskutovať
to treat [tri:t] – zaobchádzať
trust – dôvera
unresolved – nevyriešený
value – hodnota
valued – hodnotný
vital [vaɪtl] – nevyhnutný
to weaken – oslabiť
to yell – revať, kričať

to accept each other – akceptovať jeden druhého
to argue calmly – pokojne diskutovať
at least – prinajmenšom, aspoň
to be at war (with) – byť v konflikte (s)
to be in need – byť v núdzi
to be tied by – byť viazaný
to be willing to do – byť ochotný urobiť
to behave towards each other – správať sa k sebe navzájom
to bring to an end – ukončiť
to get on with each other – vychádzať navzájom
to have in common – mať niečo spoločné
high rate of divorce – vysoká miera rozvodovosti
to raise children in accordance with – vychovávať deti v súlade s
to share secrets – deliť sa o tajomstvá
to stay in touch (with) – zostať v kontakte (s)
to take each other for granted – považovať jeden druhého za samozrejmosť

□ VOCABULARY PRACTICE

Task 1 The followings expressions describe how someone feels about Peter emotionally (E) and their impressions of his appearance (A). Sort them out.



Example: He's a pain in the neck. (E)/A

a) I cannot stand him anymore. E/A

b) He wears glasses. E/A

c) He never wears shabby clothes. E/A

d) He always treats me nicely. E/A

f) He's rather tall and slim. E/A

e) He's got cute freckles on his face. E/A

g) He's a very handsome man. E/A

h) He has always been loyal and frank to me. E/A

i) I like his dark complexion. E/A

j) He's got a very particular sense of humour. E/A

k) He's really great fun to be with. E/A

l) He never pulls my leg. E/A

Task 2 Put a tick (✓) next to the qualities you like and admire in your friends.
Put a cross (X) next to those qualities that you dislike.

<i>Example:</i> tolerant	✓
amicable	
sympathetic	
trustworthy	
polite	
adventurous	
generous	
empathic	
sincere	
helpful	
reliable	
willing	
honest	
entertaining	
angry	
narrow-minded	
stubborn	

zealous	
careless	
rude	
impolite	
cruel	
self-centred	
dubious	
reluctant	
shy	
easy-going	
patient	
open-minded	
naive	
hysterical	
responsible	
sceptical	
smart	

Task 3 Are the meanings of the expressions below positive (P) or negative (N) in fruitful relationships?

→ 8

Example: to hurt somebody N

- | | | | |
|-----------------------------------|-------|--------------------------------------|-------|
| a) to care about somebody | _____ | j) to solve problems together | _____ |
| b) to get on with somebody | _____ | k) to express sympathy | _____ |
| c) to treat somebody unfairly | _____ | l) to apologise for bad behaviour | _____ |
| d) to worry about somebody | _____ | m) to bully somebody | _____ |
| e) to threaten somebody | _____ | n) to tease somebody about something | _____ |
| f) to give a hand to somebody | _____ | in a friendly way | _____ |
| g) to encourage somebody | _____ | o) to stay in touch with somebody | _____ |
| h) to cheer somebody up | _____ | p) to be on good terms with | _____ |
| i) to take each other for granted | _____ | somebody | _____ |